



Late payment reminder email: 10 you can copy, by days late (2026)

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

The four-step ladder

1. A friendly reminder, a day or two late

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER], [AMOUNT], due [DUE DATE]

Hi [FIRST NAME],

Invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT] was due on [DUE DATE], and I cannot see it in my account yet. It may have crossed with your payment.

A copy is attached. You can pay by [PAYMENT DETAILS].

If something is holding it up, tell me and we can sort it out.

[YOUR NAME]

2. A second reminder, about a week later

Subject: Second reminder: invoice [NUMBER]

Hi [FIRST NAME],

I wrote on [DATE] about invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT]. It is now [NUMBER] days past the due date of [DUE DATE].

Can you tell me by [DATE] when I can expect payment? If you have a question about the invoice, tell me what it is and I will answer it the same day.

[YOUR NAME]

3. Naming the late payment law (UK business customers)

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER]: late payment interest

Hi [FIRST NAME],

Invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT] was due on [DUE DATE] and is still unpaid.

Under the Late Payment of Commercial Debts (Interest) Act 1998 I can claim interest on a late business payment and a fixed sum towards the cost of recovery. As of [TODAY'S DATE] the interest is [INTEREST AMOUNT] and the fixed sum is [FIXED SUM].

Please pay the invoice by [DATE]. I will send a new invoice if I decide to claim the interest and the fixed sum.

[YOUR NAME]

4. A last reminder before formal steps

Subject: Final reminder: invoice [NUMBER]

Hi [FIRST NAME],

Invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT] is still unpaid, and I have not had a reply to my emails of [DATE] and [DATE].

Please pay [TOTAL NOW DUE] by [DATE]. If I have not been paid by then, I will consider formal recovery, for example a court claim.

If you would like to talk, call me on [PHONE].

[YOUR NAME]

By how late it is

7 days late

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER]: now 7 days overdue

Hi [NAME],

Invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT] was due on [DATE] and is now a week overdue. I have attached it again. Could you tell me the date you expect to pay it? If something is holding it up, let me know and I will help sort it.

Thanks,

[YOUR NAME]

30 days late

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER]: 30 days overdue

Hi [NAME],

Invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT] was due on [DATE], 30 days ago. I have not had a reply to my earlier messages. Please pay it by [DATE], or tell me by [DATE] the day you will pay. If you cannot pay it all, tell me what you can pay now and when the rest will follow.

Thanks,

[YOUR NAME]

Final notice before interest

Subject: Final notice: invoice [NUMBER]

Hi [NAME],

Invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT] is [DAYS] days overdue. If I do not receive it by [DATE],

I will add interest and costs as the law allows [ONLY IF THIS APPLIES TO YOU, AND CHECK THE RULES FIRST]. I would much rather not. Please pay, or call me on [PHONE] today.

[YOUR NAME]

Particular clients

A large client's accounts team

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER], PO [PO NUMBER]: payment status

Hello,

Could you confirm the payment status of invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT], PO [PO NUMBER], due on [DATE]? It was sent to [WHERE OR TO WHOM] on [DATE]. If it needs a different PO, a supplier form or an approval, please tell me what is missing and I will send it today. I would be grateful for the payment date.

Kind regards,

[YOUR NAME]

A friend who is a client

Subject: Quick one about the invoice

Hi [NAME],

Hope you are well. Quick, slightly awkward one: invoice [NUMBER] for [AMOUNT] was due on [DATE] and I have not seen it yet. I am sure it is just buried. Could you pay it this week, or tell me when you can? I do not want money to get in the way of us working together.

[YOUR NAME]

The client says part of it is wrong

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER]: paying the part you agree

Hi [NAME],

Thank you for telling me about [THE POINT THEY RAISED]. I will look at it by [DATE] and send a corrected invoice if it is wrong. In the meantime, please pay the [AMOUNT] that you agree is right, which is [DESCRIBE THE AGREED PART], so that only the disputed part is left to settle.

[YOUR NAME]

<https://proskillpacks.github.io/freelance/late-payment-reminder-email/>

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